

Yes. I checked the current official Government of India India Visa Online portal and related Government of India sources. Below is a consolidated, RAG-friendly explanation covering all the areas you listed.

Important: India has two fundamentally different routes: Regular/Paper Visa and e-Visa. The process, documents, appointment and biometrics differ significantly between them. The official portal also says that visa fees and procedures can vary by nationality and by the Indian Mission/visa centre handling the application. ([India Visa Online](#))

IN India Visa — Application Process & Requirements

1. How to apply for an Indian Visa

A foreign national generally has two options:

A. Regular / Paper Visa

The official process is:

1. Apply Online

Complete the online visa application form on the Government of India portal.

2. Print the application

After submission, print the completed application form and sign it.

3. Prepare supporting documents

Prepare your passport and documents required for the particular visa category.

4. Book an appointment

Where appointment scheduling is available, select an appointment with the relevant Indian Mission or Indian Visa Application Centre (IVAC).

5. Submit application and documents

Submit the printed application, passport and supporting documents at the designated IVAC or Indian Mission.

6. Pay the applicable fee

Depending on the Mission, payment may be online or at the Mission/outsourcing centre.

7. Processing

The Indian Mission/Post processes the application.

8. Receive passport/visa

Collect the passport/visa or receive it by post, depending on the local procedure. ([India Visa Online](#))

B. e-Visa

The process is much simpler:

Apply online → Upload documents/photo → Pay online → Receive ETA → Travel to India → Immigration

The official portal describes four main steps:

1. Apply online
 2. Pay e-Visa fee online
 3. Receive Electronic Travel Authorization (ETA) by email
 4. Travel to India and present the ETA at immigration. ([India Visa Online](#))
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2. Visa Fees

There is not one universal Indian Visa fee.

The fee depends on:

- Applicant's nationality
- Visa category
- Duration
- Number of entries
- Whether it is regular visa or e-Visa
- Indian Mission/visa centre
- Applicable service/processing charges

The official regular-visa portal says the fee can consist of a basic fee, special fee and processing/service fee, and the amount displayed during online registration is indicative; the final fee is determined by the relevant Mission/counter. Visa fees are generally non-refundable even if the application is withdrawn or refused. ([India Visa Online](#))

For e-Visa, the fee is country/territory specific, and the official website states that a 3% bank transaction charge is additionally charged on the applicable e-Visa fee. ([India Visa Online](#))

Important for your RAG project

I would not create a hard-coded generic "India Visa Fee = ₹X" answer in your corpus.

Instead, the assistant should answer:

"Visa fees depend on your nationality, visa type and duration. Please check the applicable fee for your nationality on the official India Visa portal."

That is much safer because visa fees can change.

3. Documents required for Indian Visa

There isn't one universal document list either. The requirements depend on the visa category.

Basic documents

For most applications, the passport is fundamental.

For e-Visa, the official portal requires:

- Passport bio page
- Recent front-facing photograph with white background
- Additional documents depending on the visa type. ([India Visa Online](#))

Examples

Visa	Additional documents
Tourist	Passport bio page + photograph
Business	Passport bio page + business card; invitation may be applicable
Medical	Passport bio page + letter from Indian hospital
Medical Attendant	Passport bio page
Student	Passport + admission letter + additional financial/support documents
Transit	Passport + confirmed onward/India travel ticket + visa/entry permit for destination
Conference	Passport + invitation + required government clearances
e-Entry / Family-related	Passport + proof of Indian origin/relationship, as applicable

The official e-Visa site provides category-specific document requirements. ([India Visa Online](#))

For example, an e-Medical Visa requires a letter from the Indian hospital containing the proposed/tentative treatment/admission details. An e-Business Visa requires a business card and may require an invitation. ([India Visa Online](#))

4. Visa Processing Time

For Regular/Paper Visa, the official India Visa Online portal states:

The Indian Mission/Post requires a minimum of three working days after receiving the application, depending on nationality and excluding special cases. ([India Visa Online](#))

So the correct RAG answer should not be:

"Indian Visa takes 3 days."

It should be:

"The official portal states a minimum of three working days for processing after receipt of the application, subject to nationality and special cases. Actual processing may vary."

For e-Visa, the applicant receives the status/ETA by email after processing; the official site says applicants should apply at least 4 days before arrival, with the permitted advance window depending on the e-Visa type. ([India Visa Online](#))

5. Visa Categories

The official Regular Visa portal lists these major categories:

Category

Tourist Visa

Business Visa

Employment / Work Visa

Student Visa

Medical Visa

Transit Visa

Journalist Visa

Family / Dependent Visa

Diplomatic Visa

Official Visa

Film Visa

Intern Visa

Foreigners of Indian Origin

Pakistan-specific Visa

Miscellaneous Visa

The official portal's visa-category page lists Business, Diplomatic, Work, Family, Journalist, Medical, Official, Pakistan Specific, Student, Tourist, Transit and Miscellaneous categories. ([India Visa Online](#))

e-Visa categories

The e-Visa system has its own categories, including:

- e-Tourist

- e-Business
- e-Medical
- e-Medical Attendant
- e-Student
- e-Transit
- e-Family
- e-Miscellaneous
- e-Entry
- e-Film
- e-Production Investment

The exact currently available subcategories and eligibility depend on the applicant's nationality and purpose. ([India Visa Online](#))

6. Which nationals do NOT require a visa for India?

For ordinary passport holders, the main visa-free arrangements include:

NP Nepal

Citizens of Nepal generally do not require a visa to enter India.

BT Bhutan

Citizens of Bhutan generally do not require a visa to enter India.

There are exceptions/conditions, particularly regarding entry from certain third countries. India's official tourism information states that Nepalese and Bhutanese citizens do not require a visa, but special documentation requirements can apply when entering India from China, Macau, Hong Kong or Pakistan. ([Incredible India](#))

MV Maldives

Maldivian citizens can enter India visa-free for tourism for up to 90 days, subject to the applicable conditions. ([Incredible India](#))

OCI

An OCI cardholder is not simply "visa-free because of nationality." OCI provides a lifelong multiple-entry visa facility to visit India, subject to OCI rules. ([Incredible India](#))

Diplomatic/Official passports

There are also numerous bilateral visa-waiver arrangements for diplomatic, official or service passport holders. The Ministry of External Affairs maintains the authoritative list. ([Ministry of External Affairs](#))

Therefore, for your RAG assistant, I'd classify this as:

Visa exemption

- |
 - |— Nepal
 - |— Bhutan
 - |— Maldives – specific conditions
 - |— OCI – separate immigration status
 - |— Diplomatic/Official passport exemptions
 - |— Country-specific agreements
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7. Who can get Visa-on-Arrival?

This is particularly important because people often confuse Visa-on-Arrival with e-Visa.

According to the official India Visa Online portal, Visa-on-Arrival is currently available to:

JP Japan

KR South Korea

AE UAE — only certain UAE nationals

For UAE nationals, the applicant must have previously obtained an Indian e-Visa or regular/paper visa. First-time UAE visitors are advised to obtain an e-Visa or regular visa before travelling. ([India Visa Online](#))

Conditions

The facility is for eligible visitors who:

- Stay in India for no more than 60 days
- Visit for tourism, business, conference or medical purposes
- Do not have residence/occupation in India
- Have a passport valid for at least six months
- Have sufficient financial means
- Have a return/onward ticket

It is not available to Diplomatic/Official passport holders and has additional restrictions for people with Pakistan-related birth/permanent-residence connections. ([India Visa Online](#))

Visa-on-Arrival airports

The official site lists six airports:

- Bengaluru

- Chennai
- Delhi
- Hyderabad
- Kolkata
- Mumbai ([India Visa Online](#))

Fee

The current official portal states:

₹2,000 or equivalent in foreign currency per passenger, including children. ([India Visa Online](#))

8. Visa Offices / Where to Submit

For a Regular/Paper Visa, the applicant submits the application either:

Indian Mission/Post

or

Indian Visa Application Centre (IVAC)

depending on the country.

The exact location depends on where the foreigner is applying from.

The official portal specifically instructs applicants to check the website of the Indian Mission concerned for detailed local information. ([India Visa Online](#))

For example, someone applying from the Netherlands would need to follow the instructions of the relevant Embassy/Indian Mission in the Netherlands, rather than assuming that the procedure is identical worldwide.

9. Online Visa Application Process — Regular Visa

The official instructions are quite detailed.

Step 1 — Go to

[India Visa Online — Government of India](#)

Step 2 — Select the Indian Mission

Select the Indian Mission from which you intend to apply.

Step 3 — Fill the application

Complete the online application according to the Ministry's standardized form.

Step 4 — Check everything carefully

This is important:

Once the application is submitted, modifications are not allowed.

Therefore, the applicant should verify all information before submitting. ([India Visa Online](#))

Step 5 — Receive Application ID

The system generates an Application ID.

The applicant should retain it for future communication and status tracking. ([India Visa Online](#))

Step 6 — Appointment/payment

The system asks whether the applicant wants to schedule an appointment and make payment online.

If available, the system provides:

- **Appointment date**
- **Appointment time**
- **Visa fee calculation**
- **Payment facility**

However, online appointment/payment isn't available for every Indian Mission. ([India Visa Online](#))

10. Biometrics

This is an important distinction between regular visa and e-Visa.

e-Visa

For e-Visa, the application is completed online, but:

Biometric details are captured at immigration when the traveller arrives in India. ([India Visa Online](#))

So:

e-Visa

Online application

↓

Upload documents

↓

Pay



ETA



Travel to India



Immigration



Biometrics captured

Regular Visa

For regular visas, the applicant must follow the biometric/fingerprinting requirements of the relevant Indian Mission or visa application centre. The exact procedure can vary by country and Mission.

Therefore, for your RAG assistant, don't make a universal statement such as "biometrics are always taken before travel."

Instead:

"Biometric requirements for regular visas depend on the Indian Mission/visa application centre. For e-Visa, biometric details are captured at immigration on arrival in India."

11. Instructions for filling the Visa application form

The official instructions provide several important rules.

One application per person

Each online application form is for one person only.

Each applicant must submit a separate application. ([India Visa Online](#))

Enter information exactly

Names, addresses, dates of birth and other details should be entered exactly as requested.

Check before submitting

The applicant should carefully verify all information.

Once submitted, the application cannot be modified. ([India Visa Online](#))

Keep Application ID

The system generates an Application ID, which should be retained for future communication.

Photograph

For the regular online application, the digital photograph must meet prescribed specifications including:

- JPEG
- 10 KB minimum
- 300 KB maximum
- Equal height and width
- Full-face/front-facing
- Eyes open
- Plain light-coloured/white background
- No shadows
- No borders

The official instructions provide the detailed photograph dimensions. ([India Visa Online](#))

12. How to take an appointment

For a Regular/Paper Visa:

Process

Complete online application



Submit application



Application ID generated



Select "Yes" for appointment



Choose available date/time



Pay online if facility exists



Print application



Attend Indian Mission / IVAC



Submit passport + documents

The official portal says that each applicant must schedule a separate appointment with the concerned Indian Mission. ([India Visa Online](#))

However, not every Indian Mission provides online appointment and e-payment. Where those facilities aren't available, the applicant prints the application and follows the local Mission's submission/payment procedure. ([India Visa Online](#))

✚ Very important for your RAG assignment

This information gives you an excellent corpus structure.

I'd divide your Visa documents into:

INDIA VISA

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| — 01 General Visa Process

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| — 02 Regular / Paper Visa

| | — Application

| | — Documents

| | — Appointment

| | — Fees

| | — Processing time

| | — Biometrics

|

| — 03 e-Visa

| | — Eligibility

| | — Categories

| | — Documents

| | — Fees

| | — Application process

| | — Biometrics

|

| — 04 Visa Categories

- | |— Tourist
- | |— Business
- | |— Employment
- | |— Student
- | |— Medical
- | |— Transit
- | |— etc.

|— 05 Visa Exemptions

|— 06 Visa-on-Arrival

|— 07 Indian Missions / Visa Offices

This is actually very suitable for testing your RAG retrieval, because you can deliberately ask questions where the answer is spread across different documents.

For example:

"I am a Japanese citizen visiting India for tourism for 20 days. Do I need to apply for a visa before travelling?"

The agent needs to retrieve nationality + Visa-on-Arrival + tourism + 60-day condition.

Or:

"I am a UAE citizen visiting India for the first time. Can I get Visa-on-Arrival?"

The answer requires retrieving the specific UAE condition, not merely the generic "Japan, South Korea and UAE are eligible." ([India Visa Online](#))

Or:

"I am eligible for Indian e-Medical Visa. What documents do I need and when should I apply?"

That requires combining the e-Visa document requirement and application timing. ([India Visa Online](#))

Official sources I'd use for your assignment

[India Visa Online — Main Portal](#)

[Regular Visa Application Process](#)

[Instructions for Regular Visa Application](#)

[Visa Fees](#)

[Visa Processing Time](#)

[Visa Categories](#)

[Visa-on-Arrival](#)

[India e-Visa Portal](#)

One correction to keep in mind for your assignment: the official website contains some overlapping/legacy information in different sections, so when we turn this into your 3–5 PDF RAG corpus, we should choose the most authoritative/current documents rather than simply saving every webpage as a PDF. That will also give you a good real-world example of why source/version/date management matters in RAG.